

CT Colonography Annotation Tool

User Test — Task Instructions

February 2026

Overview

Thank you for participating in this user test. Your feedback is essential to improving the CT Colonography Annotation Tool. This document describes the annotation tasks you will be asked to perform during the test session.

Accessing the Tool

The annotation tool is a web-based application. You will receive a personalised link and credentials via email before the test session.

Item	Details
URL	https://gracelynn-unhasty-singlehandedly.ngrok-free.dev/
Browser	Google Chrome or Mozilla Firefox (latest version)
Support Contact	Whatsapp ColonAI group / Catarina.pintomoreira@uts.edu.au

Annotation Tasks

The annotation session consists of three sequential tasks. Please complete each task fully before proceeding to the next. A demo video is available to walk you through the interface, we recommend watching it before starting.

Task 0: Getting ready

To start using our tool, make sure you follow these steps:

1. Navigate to the website: <https://gracelynn-unhasty-singlehandedly.ngrok-free.dev/>
2. In the top left panel **Load Dataset from Server**, click on **Browse Data**

3. Ensure that you are on the **Local Folder (fast)** tab, and select the folder “**CTC-8337000787**”
4. Then, select the folder “**2.000000-NA-22118**”
5. Finally, click on the blue button “**Load DICOM**”
6. This should load both the CT scan images and the Polyp Annotations
7. When this done, you are ready to start the annotation process

Task 1: Lumen Annotation (Mask Label: “Colon”)

In this first task, you will annotate the colonic lumen throughout the CT scan.

Steps:

1. Keep track of your starting time.
2. Navigate to the main annotation view.
3. Select the mask label “**Colon**” from the label selector panel.
4. Using the brush tool, annotate the colonic lumen on each relevant slice.
5. Use the scroll wheel or slice navigator to move through slices.
6. Adjust brush size as needed for different regions of the colon.
7. Use Refine to Edges to fill the region you annotated
8. Use the Mask Propagation functionality to propagate your annotation to N slices
9. When finished, verify your annotations by scrolling through the full volume.
10. Keep track of your end time
11. Click on “**Export All Masks**” to keep a record in your computer and rename the file to **task1.nii.gz**

Tip

You can use the mask propagation feature to speed up annotation of consecutive slices with similar lumen shapes.

Task 2: Fluid Pocket Annotation (Mask Label: “Fluid Pockets”)

Once the lumen annotation is complete, annotate any visible fluid pockets within the colon.

Steps:

12. Ensure Task 1 (Colon lumen) is fully complete.
13. Keep track of your starting time
14. Switch the mask label to **“Fluid Pockets”** in the label selector panel.
15. Identify and annotate all fluid pockets visible in the scan.
1. Use the fluid-aware segmentation tools if available to assist with boundary delineation.
2. Use Refine to Edges to fill the region you annotated
3. Use the Mask Propagation functionality to propagate your annotation to N slices
4. Scroll through the volume to check for any missed fluid regions.
5. Keep track of your end time
6. Click on **“Export All Masks”** to keep a record in your computer and rename the file to **task1and2.nii.gz**

Task 3: Polyp Annotation (Mask Label: “Polyps”)

The final task involves annotating polyps using a dedicated annotation tab.

Steps:

7. Ensure Task1 and Task2 are complete.
8. Hide the masks with labels “Colon” and “Fluid Pockets”
9. Keep track of your starting time
10. Select the mask label **“Polyps”** from the label selector.
11. Navigate to the **Polyp Annotations** tab in the interface (in the bottom).
12. Click on the slice numbers to jump directly to the slices where it has been reported **at least one polyp**. You can use the checkboxes to keep track of the polyps you identified.
13. For each annotated polyp, use the **Comments** section to describe **why** you identified it as a polyp.
14. Keep track of your end time
15. Change the visibility of the mask labels “Colon” and “Fluid Pockets” to visible
16. Click on **“Export All Masks”** to keep a record in your computer and rename the file to **task_complete.nii.gz**
17. Click on **“Send Mask to Server”** and wait

🔔 Comment Guidelines

Imagine you are teaching a trainee radiologist. Your comment should explain the visual and morphological cues that led you to identify this structure as a polyp.

Consider mentioning: shape characteristics, surface texture, contrast enhancement pattern, size, location, and any features that distinguish it from normal folds or residual material.

Task Summary

Task	Annotation Target	Mask Label	Additional Action
1	Colonic lumen	Colon	—
2	Fluid pockets	Fluid Pockets	Be mindful to select the right brush.
3	Polyps	Polyps	Add explanatory comment for each polyp

General Guidelines

- Complete tasks in order (Colon → Fluid Pockets → Polyps).
- If you encounter any bugs or unexpected behaviour, please note the slice number and describe the issue.
- If you are unsure about an annotation, make your best judgement and note your uncertainty in the comments.

Support & Contact

If you experience any technical issues or have questions about the task, please reach out:

- Email: Catarina.pintomoreira@uts.edu.au
- ColonAI Whatsapp group

Thank you for your time and expertise!